

INDY PROPERTY GUIDE

Home Selling Prep Guide

30-Day Timeline, Room-by-Room Checklist & Pricing Strategy · Indianapolis & Central Indiana

Section 1: Your 30-Day Pre-Listing Timeline

Selling a home in Indianapolis takes preparation. This week-by-week timeline keeps you on track from your first call to listing day.

- Day 1-5

Schedule a Pre-Listing Consultation
Meet with your agent for a CMA, pricing discussion, and strategy session. This is where you set the foundation for a successful sale.
- Day 5-10

Declutter and Depersonalize
Remove personal photos, excess furniture, and seasonal items. Rent a storage unit if needed. Help buyers picture themselves living here.
- Day 10-15

Deep Clean Everything
Hire professionals for carpets, windows, and pressure washing. Clean inside cabinets, appliances, and closets — buyers look everywhere.
- Day 15-20

Handle Repairs and Touch-Ups
Fix leaky faucets, squeaky doors, cracked tiles, burned-out bulbs. Touch up paint on scuffed walls. Eliminate inspection-period objections.
- Day 20-25

Professional Photos and Listing Prep
Your agent coordinates photography, writes the description, and sets up showings. Great photos are the single most important marketing asset.
- Day 25-30

Go Live on MLS
Your home hits MIBOR MLS, syndicating to Zillow, Realtor.com, Redfin, and 500+ platforms. Full marketing campaign launches and showings begin.

Pro Tip

The first two weeks on MLS get the most attention. Homes that are fully prepped, professionally photographed, and priced right from day one consistently receive more showings and stronger offers.

Section 2: Room-by-Room Prep Checklist

Go through each area before listing photos. Buyers notice details — and so do their agents.

Kitchen

- ☐ Clean and organize countertops — keep only 2-3 decorative items
- ☐ Deep clean inside oven, microwave, and refrigerator
- ☐ Fix any dripping faucets or running water
- ☐ Replace burned-out bulbs under cabinets
- ☐ Remove magnets, papers, and clutter from refrigerator front

Bathrooms

- ☐ Re-caulk tubs and showers if discolored
- ☐ Replace worn towels with fresh white ones for showings
- ☐ Fix any running toilets or slow drains
- ☐ Clean grout lines and remove any mildew
- ☐ Add a fresh shower curtain

Living Areas

- ☐ Remove excess furniture — buyers need to see the space
- ☐ Clean or replace worn carpet
- ☐ Touch up scuffed baseboards and walls
- ☐ Arrange furniture to showcase room size and flow
- ☐ Clean windows inside and out

Bedrooms

- ☐ Make beds with fresh, neutral bedding
- ☐ Clear nightstands and dressers
- ☐ Organize closets — half-full closets look bigger
- ☐ Remove personal photos and memorabilia

Exterior & Curb Appeal

- ☐ Power wash driveway, walkways, and siding
- ☐ Mow, edge, and mulch landscape beds
- ☐ Paint or replace the front door if worn
- ☐ Add potted plants or flowers near the entrance
- ☐ Clean gutters and repair any visible damage
- ☐ Make sure house numbers are visible and mailbox is in good shape

Section 3: Pricing Your Home Right

What a CMA Is and Why It Matters

A Comparative Market Analysis uses recent sales of similar nearby homes to determine what the market will actually pay. This is data-driven pricing, not a guess.

The Danger of Overpricing

Overpriced homes sit longer, accumulate days on market that signal desperation, and almost always sell for less than if priced correctly from the start. Price reductions are public and invite lowball offers.

Strategic Pricing Works

Homes priced at or slightly below market value generate more showings, more competition, and often receive multiple offers — driving the final sale price up, not down.

What NOT to Base Your Price On

- **What you paid** — the market cares about comps, not your purchase price
- **What you "need" to walk away with** — your needs don't change what buyers will pay
- **Zillow's Zestimate alone** — automated estimates can be off by tens of thousands

Indiana-Specific Costs

Seller closing costs typically run 6-8% of the sale price, including commissions, title insurance, and transfer taxes. Your agent prepares a seller net sheet so you know exactly what you'll walk away with before accepting an offer.

Section 4: What to Expect During Showings

- **Leave for all showings** — buyers are more honest and comfortable when sellers aren't present
- **Stay show-ready daily** — develop a 30-minute pickup routine so you can leave quickly

- **Secure valuables and medications** — lock them in a safe or take them with you
- **Leave lights on, blinds open** — bright homes show dramatically better
- **Have a pet plan** — remove pets during showings; pet odor is a top buyer objection

Section 5: From Offer to Closing

Reviewing Offers

Price isn't everything. Evaluate each offer on: purchase price, financing strength, contingencies, earnest money, closing date, and seller concessions.

Inspection Period

Most Indiana contracts include a 10-day inspection window. Buyers may request repairs or credits. Your agent advises which requests are reasonable.

Appraisal

Buyer's lender orders an appraisal to confirm value. If it comes in low, options include: buyer covers the gap, price adjustment, or renegotiation.

Final Walkthrough

Buyer confirms the home is in agreed-upon condition and negotiated repairs are complete. Standard process — not a second inspection.

Closing Day

Bring your ID to the title company. Sign documents, hand over keys, receive proceeds via wire transfer — typically same day or next business day.

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